

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Struggling to close clients without a portfolio?

Here is the loop you are in, and three ways out of it.

03



@csos

Swipe →

THE PORTFOLIO LOOP

BLOCK 1

**You cannot get clients
without a portfolio.**

BLOCK 2

**You cannot build a
portfolio without
clients.**

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE DAY TO DAY

It gets hard to sit at the desk for outreach hours.

Outreach stops feeling exciting, and the niche you picked two months ago gets swapped for a new one.

Nothing you start actually ships.

Nothing you start actually ships.

A PORTFOLIO IS NOT HOW YOU ESCAPE

Prospects do not read portfolios the way creative strategists think they do.

What a prospect actually reads is a piece of thinking about their own business.

That piece you can write today.

That piece you can write today.

04

ROUTE ONE. PUBLIC TEARDOWN

Take one ad and break it down every week in public.

Post a screenshot. Write three sentences on what you see, what you would test next, and what you expect to happen.

Eight weeks, eight posts, a body of visible thinking.

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ROUTE TWO. STRATEGY DOCUMENT

One page, sent first, with no ask attached.

Pick five businesses. Write one page for each about who the offer is for, why it is selling, and what you would do next.

Send it without a rate and without a services page.

Send it without a rate and without a services page.

ROUTE THREE. SPEC WORK

Write the creative strategy you wish the brand had in place.

Pick three brands, and publish each piece with your name on it.

Slower than the other two, and more polished at the end.

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PICK THE ONE YOU WILL ACTUALLY FINISH

The creative strategists who stay stuck are the ones who pick all three routes and finish none of them.

Pick one route, send or publish it inside two weeks, and start a second route the day after.

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The portfolio was never the real blocker.

The real blocker was not sending the thinking.

Send the thinking this week.

The real blocker was not sending the thinking.

NEXT STEP

Not sure which route fits where you are?

Take the creative strategy test at
adsc creativestrategy.com/quiz.

→ adsc creativestrategy.com/quiz